

FAQs

Read carefully

Q. My CD-ROM drive is driving me nuts. It reads every software CD as an audio CD. How do I put some sense into it?
Yudhveer Singh

A. Such drives can be so irritating! The problem lies with the CD-ROM lens that is functioning erratically. Clean the CD-ROM lens using a lens-cleaner disc. Get it serviced at the nearest repair centre if the problem persists.

Boot out the choice

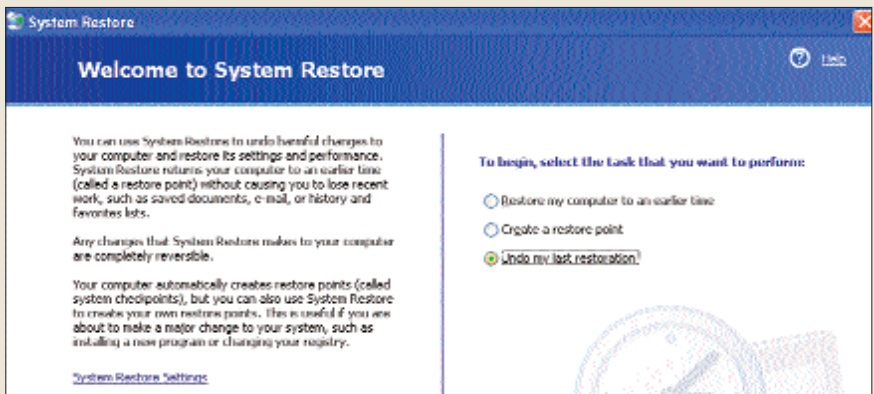
Q. I have Windows XP Professional loaded on my C: drive. Some time back, I installed Windows 98SE on the D: drive. This gave me a dual boot option. However, recently I formatted the D: drive and created a new partition after removing all traces of Windows 98SE. In spite of that, I still get a dual-boot screen asking me to choose between Windows XP and Windows 98. How do I get rid of that?
Tehseen Ali

A. Open the boot.ini file using Notepad, delete the following line: C:\="windows 98" and then save the file. The option will not appear the next time you boot your PC.

Restoring data

Q. I am using Windows XP Professional on a Pentium 4 system. Recently, my display and sound drivers were acting nasty. Hence, I reinstalled them, but to no avail. I then restored the system to an earlier time, and lost valuable software that I installed after the restoration point. There was no point available for the restoration when I tried to undo the changes. I don't have the CDs of the aforementioned software, so I can't reinstall them either. Is there any way to get back that software?
Shailesh

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As the name suggests, 'Undo my last restoration' helps you recover data that is lost due to a prior restoration

A. Whenever you restore the system to an earlier point, Windows XP creates a restore point, and then proceeds with the restore. To undo the change, go to **Accessibility > System Tools > System Restore** and select 'Undo my last restoration'. If the restore point is not present then you might have disabled the system restore functionality. If so, then, pal, you have our condolences! You won't be able to go back to the said state.

Try using recovery software such as R-Fat, but it's doubtful whether you will ever retrieve the files since recovery is possible only until the physical location where the files are stored remains unused.

processor, modem, monitor, or the TV tuner card?

Lastly, I intend buying a PC, primarily to play games. Which OS should I opt for—Windows XP Professional or Windows XP Home Edition?
Akhil Bahri

A. Firmware is software that's embedded in the hardware. It's accessible through specially written applications that can write or read from the ROM chip, where the firmware resides. For instance, the BIOS on the motherboard is the firmware. As and when manufacturers discover bugs in the hardware, they put up specific updates to overcome them. Firmware updates can also help overcoming hardware limitations.

Assume that your current AMD board supports a 166 FSB processor. Later, if AMD releases a 200 FSB CPU, then the motherboard manufacturer may release a firmware update so that your board also supports it.

In the case of such cards as TV-tuners, the manufacturer may release an update to support a new motherboard. Motherboards often require firmware updates for supporting newer features and hardware.

Finally, load Windows XP Home on your PC if gaming is your main need. It shores up to the needs of most games and is easy on the pocket too.

Dreadfully blue

Q. I have an Intel Pentium 4 1.7 GHz with a VIA P4M266-8233 motherboard, an S-Media GFX 5200 128 MB DDR graphics card, a 40 GB hard disk with dual operating systems—Windows 98 and Windows XP—and 256 MB SDRAM. I get the following blue-screen error message when uninstalling Realtek AC '97 for VIA audio drivers in Windows 98 to update them: "A fatal error has occurred at 0028:ff066a7b in vxd portcls(05) + 00003afb, the current application will be terminated." What do I do?
Neelonjon Goon

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A. Looks like driver corruption is at play here. Here's what you do: Hold down the Windows key and [Pause] to access the Properties of My Computer. Flip over to the Device Manager. Here, right-click Sound, select Properties and choose Update drivers. If this does not even allow you to overwrite the newer drivers, then restart your PC, go to the BIOS, disable Sound and then uninstall the old drivers. Restart again, enable sound in the BIOS and then reinstall the drivers. ■



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E-mail us your computing problems, and we may answer them here!
Since we get more

mails per day than we can handle, it may take some time for your query to be answered. Rest assured, we are listening!